BLOOD DONATION INFORMATION GUIDE

BloodConnect - Medical Reference Document

WHO CAN DONATE BLOOD?

Age must be between 18 and 65 years.

Weight must be more than 50 kg.

Hemoglobin must be minimum 12.5 g/dL.

Gap between donations must be at least 90 days.

Must be in good general health.

CAN DIABETICS DONATE BLOOD?

People with well-controlled diabetes managed by diet or tablets can donate blood.

Those on insulin therapy should consult a doctor before donating.

People with Type 2 diabetes who are stable can safely donate blood.

BLOOD GROUP COMPATIBILITY

O Negative is the universal donor and can donate to all blood groups.

AB Positive is the universal recipient and can receive from all blood groups.

A Positive can donate to A+ and AB+.

A Negative can donate to A+, A-, AB+, AB-.

B Positive can donate to B+ and AB+.

B Negative can donate to B+, B-, AB+, AB-.

O Positive can donate to A+, B+, O+ and AB+.

AB Negative can donate to AB+ and AB-.

WHAT TO DO BEFORE DONATING?

Eat a healthy meal before donation.

Drink plenty of water before donating.

Avoid alcohol for 24 hours before donation.

Avoid fatty foods on donation day.

Get a good nights sleep before donating.

Avoid smoking 2 hours before donation.

WHAT HAPPENS DURING DONATION?

Registration and health check happens first.

Hemoglobin test is conducted.

Blood pressure is checked.

Temperature is measured.

Actual blood collection takes 8 to 10 minutes.

Rest and refreshments are provided after donation.

Total process takes about 30 minutes.

BENEFITS OF BLOOD DONATION

One blood donation can save up to 3 lives.

Blood donation reduces risk of heart disease.

Donors get a free health screening.

Blood donation burns approximately 650 calories.

Regular donation reduces iron overload in body.

Stimulates production of new blood cells.

COMMON MYTHS ABOUT BLOOD DONATION

Myth: Blood donation makes you weak.

Fact: Your body replenishes blood within 24 to 48 hours.

Myth: Blood donation is very painful.

Fact: You only feel a small pinch when the needle is inserted.

Myth: You can get diseases from donating blood.

Fact: Sterile single-use needles are always used and discarded.

Myth: People with tattoos cannot donate blood.

Fact: You can donate 6 months after getting a tattoo.

WHO CANNOT DONATE BLOOD?

People with HIV, Hepatitis B or Hepatitis C cannot donate.

People who have had cancer cannot donate.

People with heart disease cannot donate.

Pregnant women cannot donate blood.

People who have had surgery in last 6 months should wait.

People with active cold or fever should wait until recovered.

BLOOD DONATION FACTS

Every 2 seconds someone in the world needs blood.

Only 7 percent of people have O negative blood group.

38 percent of population is eligible but only 10 percent donate.

Blood cannot be manufactured - it can only come from donors.

Platelets must be used within 5 days of donation.

Red blood cells can be stored for up to 42 days.

One unit of blood contains about 450 ml.

EMERGENCY BLOOD CONTACTS IN INDIA

National Blood Transfusion Helpline: 1800-180-1104 (Free)

Emergency Ambulance: 108 (Free)

eRaktKosh Government Portal: 104 (Free)

Red Cross Blood Bank Delhi: 011-23711551

Apollo Blood Bank: 1860-500-1066

AIIMS Blood Bank: 011-26588500